Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Helicobacter Pylori Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023010
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Urea breath testing (CPT code 83013, CPT code 83014) or stool antigen testing (CPT code 87338) for *H. pylori* infection **IS REIMBURSABLE**, no more than one test every four weeks, for any of the following situations:
  - Active peptic ulcer disease (PUD)
  - Dyspeptic symptoms including abdominal pain, nausea or vomiting
  - Early satiety
  - Gastric intestinal metaplasia (GIM)
  - Gastric or duodenal ulcers or erosions
  - Iron deficiency anemia
  - Low-grade gastric mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue (MALT) lymphoma
  - Long term usage of a non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drug (NSAID) or aspirin
  - Past PUD without *H. pylori* history
  - Personal history of resection of the digestive tract
  - Personal or family history of gastric cancer
  - To measure the success of eradication for individuals with an *H. pylori* infection
- For individuals with a refractory *H. pylori* infection, nucleic acid-based susceptibility testing (CPT code 87513, CPT code 0008U*) **IS REIMBURSABLE.**
- Serologic testing for *H. pylori* infection (CPT code 83009, CPT code 86677, CPT code 87339) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.
- For individuals diagnosed with an *H. pylori* infection, single-step serologic testing for *H.pylori* (CPT code 86318) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**
- For all other situations not addressed above, urea breath testing (CPT code 83013, CPT code 83014), stool antigen testing (CPT code 87338) or nucleic acid-based susceptibility testing (CPT code 87513, CPT code 0008U*) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**
- Stool antigen testing (CPT code 87338) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** when performed simultaneously with the urea breath test (CPT code 83013).

- Urea breath testing (CPT code 83013, CPT code 83014) or stool antigen testing (CPT code 87338) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** when performed simultaneously with biopsy-based testing (CPT code 88305).

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
83009	Helicobacter pylori, blood test analysis for urease activity, non-radioactive isotope (eg, C-13)
83013	Helicobacter pylori; breath test analysis for urease activity, non-radioactive isotope (e.g. C-13)
83014	Helicobacter pylori; drug administration
86318	Immunoassay for infectious agent antibody(ies), qualitative or semiquantitative, single step-method (eg, reagent strip);
86677	Antibody; Helicobacter pylori
87338	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay technique, (eg, enzyme immunoassay [EIA], enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay [ELISA], fluorescence immunoassay [FIA], immunochemiluminometric assay [IMCA]) qualitative or semiquantitative; Helicobacter pylori, stool
87339	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay technique, (eg, enzyme immunoassay [EIA], enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay [ELISA], fluorescence immunoassay [FIA], immunochemiluminometric assay [IMCA]) qualitative or semiquantitative; Helicobacter pylori
87513	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Helicobacter pylori (H. pylori), clarithromycin resistance, amplified probe technique
88305	Level IV - Surgical pathology, gross and microscopic examination Abortion - spontaneous/missed Artery, biopsy Bone marrow, biopsy Bone exostosis Brain/meninges, other than for tumor resection Breast, biopsy, not requiring microscopic evaluation of surgical margins Breast, reduction mammoplasty Bronchus, biopsy Cell block, any source Cervix, biopsy Colon, biopsy Duodenum, biopsy Endocervix, curettings/biopsy Endometrium, curettings/biopsy Esophagus, biopsy Extremity, amputation, traumatic Fallopian tube, biopsy Fallopian tube, ectopic pregnancy Femoral head, fracture Fingers/toes, amputation, non-traumatic Gingiva/oral mucosa, biopsy Heart valve Joint, resection Kidney, biopsy Larynx, biopsy Leiomyoma(s), uterine myomectomy - without uterus Lip, biopsy/wedge resection Lung, transbronchial biopsy Lymph node, biopsy Muscle, biopsy Nasal mucosa, biopsy Nasopharynx/oropharynx, biopsy Nerve, biopsy Odontogenic/dental cyst Omentum, biopsy Ovary with or without tube, non-neoplastic Ovary, biopsy/wedge resection Parathyroid gland Peritoneum, biopsy Pituitary tumor Placenta, other than third trimester Pleura/pericardium - biopsy/tissue Polyp, cervical/endometrial Polyp, colorectal Polyp, stomach/small intestine Prostate, needle biopsy Prostate, TUR Salivary gland, biopsy Sinus, paranasal biopsy Skin, other than cyst/tag/debridement/plastic repair Small intestine, biopsy Soft tissue, other than tumor/mass/lipoma/debridement Spleen Stomach, biopsy Synovium Testis, other than tumor/biopsy/castration Thyroglossal duct/brachial cleft cyst Tongue, biopsy Tonsil, biopsy Trachea, biopsy Ureter, biopsy Urethra, biopsy Urinary bladder, biopsy Uterus, with or without tubes and ovaries, for prolapse Vagina, biopsy Vulva/labia, biopsy
0008U*	Helicobacter pylori detection and antibiotic resistance, DNA, 16S and 23S rRNA, gyrA, pbp1, rdxA and rpoB, next-generation sequencing, formalin-fixed paraffin-embedded or fresh tissue or fecal

Procedure Code	Code Description
	sample, predictive, reported as positive or negative for resistance to clarithromycin, fluoroquinolones, metronidazole, amoxicillin, tetracycline, and rifabutin Proprietary test: AmHPR H. Antibiotic Resistance Panel Lab/Manufacturer: American Molecular Laboratories, Inc

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
CGS Administrators, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Tests (MDT)	L36021	0008U
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Tests (MDT)	L35160	0008U
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Tests (MDT)	L36256	0008U
Palmetto GBA	MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Tests (MDT)	L35025	0008U
First Coast Service Options, Inc.	Billing and Coding: Molecular Pathology and Genetic Testing	A58918	0008U
Novitas Solutions, Inc.	Biomarkers Overview	L35062	0008U

**The payment criterion for 0008U applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, LLC, Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC and Palmetto GBA, First Coast Service Options, Inc, Novitas Solutions, Inc.*

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